

If Something Happens — Start Here

The first page anyone should read

PREPARED BY

LAST UPDATED

THE FIRST FIVE CALLS, IN ORDER

#	WHO	WHY	PHONE
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

WHERE THE IMPORTANT THINGS ARE

THIS ORGANIZER LIVES

ORIGINAL WILL & LEGAL DOCUMENTS

FIRE SAFE / SAFE DEPOSIT BOX & KEY

PASSWORD MANAGER MASTER KEY

DEEDS, TITLES & POLICIES

TAKE A BREATH FIRST

- Nothing has to be decided today. Almost none of this is urgent in the first week.
- Order 10 certified death certificates — nearly every institution wants an original.
- Do not close accounts or sell anything until the executor and attorney say so.

Estate Snapshot

What you own, what you owe, what's exposed

THE MATH	AMOUNT
Total assets	
– Total debts	
= NET ESTATE	
Assets with no beneficiary / joint owner	
= SHARE EXPOSED TO PROBATE	
× probate cost estimate	
= ROUGH COST OF PROBATE	
Cash a survivor could reach in days	

MONTHLY HOUSEHOLD COST

= MONTHS OF RUNWAY

LIFE INSURANCE IN FORCE

TOTAL ASSETS

OF WHICH EXPOSED TO PROBATE

What is owed and who to call

[illegible]**TOTAL OWED**

TOTAL MONTHLY

[illegible]

- A beneficiary designation beats your will. If they disagree, the form wins.
- Anything with no beneficiary and no joint owner goes through probate.

Legal Document Checklist

The ten that decide everything

☐**Will**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**Living trust**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**Financial power of attorney**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**Healthcare power of attorney**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**Living will / advance directive**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**HIPAA release**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**Beneficiary designations reviewed**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**Letter of instruction**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**Digital asset authorization**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

☐**Funeral & burial wishes**

WHERE IT IS KEPT

PREPARED BY / DATE

[illegible]

AGENT / BROKER

DO NOT WRITE ACTUAL PASSWORDS ON THIS PAGE. Record where each one lives.

[illegible]

PHONE PIN — WHERE KEPT

The calls someone would need to make

[illegible]

EXECUTOR NAMED IN THE WILL

ATTORNEY

Medical & Care

Print this one for the fridge

NAME	DATE OF BIRTH	BLOOD TYPE
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ITEM	DETAIL
Allergies	
Ongoing conditions	
Current medications	
Pharmacy	
Primary physician	
Specialists	
Health insurance & member #	
Resuscitation wishes	
Organ donation	
Preferred hospital	
Who decides if I can't	
Mobility & daily care needs	
Vision, hearing & dental	
Anything else they should know	

Final Wishes

In your words, so nobody has to guess

ITEM	WHAT I WANT
Burial or cremation	
Service	
Where	
Readings or music	
Who should speak	
Flowers or donations	
Obituary	
Who to notify first	
Pre-paid arrangements	
Estimated cost & how to pay it	
What I'd like said	
Anything else	

Household Instructions

The small practical things

ITEM	INSTRUCTION
Water shut-off	
Electrical panel	
Furnace & filter size	
Spare keys	
Fire safe combination is with	
Pets — who takes them & the vet	
Lawn & snow	
Utilities & autopay	
Mail — stop or forward	
Safe deposit box & key	
Anything that would confuse someone	

ONE LAST THING

- Tell one person this file exists and where it is. That is the whole point.
- Review it every year, and after any birth, death, marriage or move.